

HISTORY, GOVERNMENT AND SOCIAL STUDIES

Standards Alignment Toolkit



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HISTORY, GOVERNMENT AND SOCIAL STUDIES STANDARDS ALIGNMENT TOOLKIT

Overview

Purpose of the Toolkit

The Standards Alignment Toolkit supports educators with aligning curriculum, instruction, and assessments with the Kansas State Standards, the first step toward ensuring all students receive a high-quality education. This toolkit is designed to reduce the time and effort required to break down or make sense of the standards, enabling teachers to focus more on preparing to deliver meaningful instruction that fosters student engagement.

This Standards Alignment Toolkit offers:

- Guidance to deeply understand and internalize the expectations of the Kansas State Standards
- Insights into the interconnectedness of the standards, including vertically (across grade levels) and horizontally (within grade levels)
- Instructional resources to support the delivery of content that is coherent, relevant, and aligned with the expectations of the standards

By aligning standards, curriculum, and assessments, the toolkit plays a critical role in ensuring that:

- Instruction is cohesive, building logically on prior knowledge while also preparing students for future learning.
- Instructional materials are relevant and tailored to meet students' unique learning needs.
- Students are set up for success with the knowledge and skills they need to meet the expectations of grade-level learning outcomes.

KSDE recognizes that a deep understanding of and alignment to Kansas State Standards is essential to ensuring that all students receive an excellent education. **This toolkit simplifies the process of standards alignment, equipping educators with the tools they need to enhance student success while focusing on what matters most—providing effective and meaningful instruction.**

How to Use the Toolkit

Teachers might use this toolkit to:

- Engage in a guided process to internalize what their grade-level standards expect students to know and be able to do by the end of the year
- Leverage a deeper understanding of the standards to assess student learning aligned to the standards and the alignment of instructional materials: Are the lessons and units I'm currently using fully aligned to the depth of the standards? If not, how can or should I fill those gaps?
- Use provided resources, templates, and processes to plan for upcoming units and/or lessons.

School, district and regional leaders might use this toolkit to:

- Deepen their understanding of the grade-level standards for the content areas they coach and/or support in other ways (e.g. professional development).
- Align on language and resources used within the content area to be better equipped to support educators with content-specific development

HISTORY, GOVERNMENT AND SOCIAL STUDIES STANDARDS ALIGNMENT TOOLKIT

Standards Alignment Process

Curriculum/Standards alignment involves several key steps to ensure that educational content being taught is coherent, relevant, and effectively represents what students at each grade level should know and be able to do. It involves three-way alignment between standards, curriculum (the intentional plan and resources for guiding students to learn what is necessary to meet the standard) and assessment (an examination of to what extent the student meets the standard).

Carefully aligning curriculum to standards is a process that takes time. It also requires intentionality, communication and a desire to closely reflect on the effectiveness of our practices and resources. It is a process that is most successful if all teachers are fully engaged in the process. Carefully planned professional learning will be needed throughout this process. The following steps will lead educators through the process.

1. **Define learning outcomes by close examination and “unpacking” of the standards:**
 - a. Articulate the details of the desired learning outcomes for students.
 - b. Build educator knowledge related to the rigor and text complexity necessary for students to meet grade level expectations.
2. **Vertical alignment:**
 - a. Clarify content across grade levels/ grade bands (vertical alignment), recognizing the specific expectations for the level of understanding students are expected to have at that grade level, the grade above and the grade below.
 - b. Identify how skills and knowledge are sequentially built from one grade to the next.
3. **Horizontal alignment:**
 - a. Identify how/when the content standards are addressed within a grade level (horizontal alignment).
 - b. Clarify if there is a district-wide scope and instructional sequence.
 - c. Intentionally collaborate to coordinate instruction of grade level content across subjects.
 - d. Review standards and the assessment blueprint.
4. **Analyze existing curriculum:**
 - a. Review the current curriculum adopted. In review, consider any required or recommended learning objectives, content, and assessments.
 - b. Focus on the Depth of Knowledge (DOK) and text complexity for each grade level to assure adequate rigor.
 - c. Identify any gaps, redundancies, or outdated resources.
 - d. Identify if Tier 1 (core) curriculum is aligned with the components of structured literacy (explicit, systematic, cumulative, scaffolded, highly interactive, multimodal, specific feedback, and data driven) and elements of structured literacy (phonemes and graphemes, morphemes, vocabulary, text structure, orthographic conventions, stress and syllable patterns, critical thinking, sentence structure/grammar).

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5. Assessments alignment and timeline:

- a. Align all assessments (quizzes, tests, projects) with learning outcomes.
- b. Select continuing formative assessments that will inform instruction.

6. Map content and skills:

- a. Map existing content (lessons, units, activities) to the defined learning outcomes.
- b. Ensure that text used in instruction is at the appropriate level of complexity for grade level expectation and rigor, allowing all students access to content.
- c. Ensure curriculum is aligned with structured literacy.
- d. Identify specific gaps of content or skills that may exist and identify or create supplemental materials to fill the gaps.

7. Monitor and revise:

- a. Continuously monitor student performance and adjust as needed. Plan intentionally for all educators to be actively involved in data analysis and interpretation to determine changes that should be made.
- b. Regularly review and update the curriculum based on feedback and data.

Remember that curriculum alignment is an ongoing process, and collaboration among teachers, administrators, and stakeholders is crucial for its success!

The purpose of this document is to:

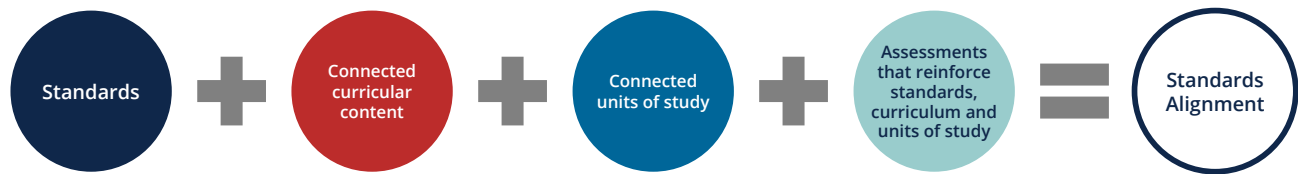
1. Define History, Government and Social Studies (HGSS) standards alignment.
2. Describe the basic components of HGSS Standards Alignment, including, but not limited to standards, curriculum and assessments.
3. Provide a planning framework for educators, instructional coaches and curriculum coordinators as they develop and create HGSS unit planning.
4. Provide a coaching tool for elevating standards alignment in high quality HGSS instruction and implementation.

“It is easier to build strong children than to repair broken men.”

- Frederick Douglass

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What is Standards Alignment?



Four Fundamentals

In Kansas, building capacity to elevate and unlock opportunities for all students and reduce limitations involves the Four Fundamentals at the district, school building, and classroom levels:

STRUCTURED LITERACY

We provide literacy instruction in pre-K-12 aligned to the science of reading and assure teachers and admin are well-trained and knowledgeable in the elements and implementation of structured literacy.

Structured Literacy refers to the explicit, systematic, diagnostic, and cumulative approach to teaching literacy that acknowledges the value of both word recognition and oral and written language comprehension as evidenced in all grades and disciplines.

STANDARDS-ALIGNMENT

We align lessons, instruction, and materials to Kansas standards and clearly identify what students must know and be able to do. This includes interpersonal, intrapersonal, and cognitive skills in pre-K-12.

Standards-Alignment has clearly defined student learning expectations aligned to Kansas State HGSS Standards and supported with evidence-based instruction and materials. Content, lessons, instruction, and materials should support the HGSS standards.

BALANCED ASSESSMENT

We assess students for risk and standards in pre-K-12 and use data to adjust instruction. We have a deep understanding of the purpose of each assessment and how to use the data to raise achievement.

A Balanced Assessment system refers to a collection of varying types of assessments that provide feedback regarding instruction and student learning. It utilizes assessment as a measure for learning and of learning.

QUALITY INSTRUCTION

We have a culture of high expectations in our classrooms and provide each student access to grade-level standards and content through high-quality instructional materials in pre-K-12.

Quality Instruction refers to implementation of evidence-based lesson design that reflects high expectations, meaningful student engagement, and learning activities aligned to the Kansas State Standards. A data-driven system of differentiated supports is necessary to help each student meet rigorous state standards.

For more information concerning HGSS standards and benchmarks visit the [HGSS webpage](https://www.ksde.gov/Agency/Division-of-Learning-Services/Career-Standards-and-Assessment-Services/Content-Area-F-L/History-Government-and-Social-Studies)¹ which includes standards, benchmarks, CBA, rubrics, etc.

¹ KSDE. History, Government, and Social Studies (HGSS).

<https://www.ksde.gov/Agency/Division-of-Learning-Services/Career-Standards-and-Assessment-Services/Content-Area-F-L/History-Government-and-Social-Studies>

Discipline Literacy and Skills

Tim Shanahan and Cynthia Shanahan, in their article *“What Is Disciplinary Literacy and Why Does It Matter,”*² contend that disciplinary literacy emphasizes the knowledge and abilities possessed by those who create, communicate, and use knowledge within the disciplines, such as social studies, science, math, English language arts, etc. It honors the thinking within disciplines of study and invites students to engage in the academic discipline while developing a voice as a member of that community.

Disciplinary literacy requires students to read in a variety of mediums and write in specialized ways for specialized purposes determined by the discipline (Moje, 2008; Shanahan and Shanahan, 2008). Each discipline requires students to employ particular knowledge, tools, and abilities to communicate, create, and use information within that discipline (Shanahan and Shanahan, 2012).

Disciplinary skills include analysis, interpretation, compare and contrast, evaluation, cause and effect, contextualization, corroboration, summarization, questioning, sequencing, sourcing, reasoning, mapping, etc.

² Refsnes, H. (1970, January 1). *What is Disciplinary Literacy and Why Does it Matter* | Shanahan on Literacy. Shanahan on Literacy. <https://www.shanahanonliteracy.com/publications/what-is-disciplinary-literacy-and-why-does-it-matter>

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

Suggested Scope and Sequence

Kindergarten-12 classes should embed the disciplines of history, government, economics, geography and the humanities within each course.

Teachers in kindergarten through fourth grade link content learning to a *“Focus”* Standard(s). The Focus Standard{hyperlink} allow teachers to set that standard as a theme around which social studies instruction at that grade-level takes place. As instruction progresses through grades K-4, teachers enforce previous learning around standards taught earlier while linking content learning to the Focus Standards at their grade-level. Refer to Instructional Guidance for the Elementary Classroom for daily time allotment recommendations on p. 9.

Middle and high level courses should teach and reinforce all standards woven throughout the curriculum.

Kindergarten

Content Focus	Focus Standard	Teaching and Reinforcing Standard
Sense of self	1	1

Grade 1

Content Focus	Focus Standard	Teaching and Reinforcing Standard
Role of individuals	2	1, 2

Grade 2

Content Focus	Focus Standard	Teaching and Reinforcing Standard
Societies then and now	4	1, 2

Grade 3

Content Focus	Focus Standard	Teaching and Reinforcing Standard
Local and National Communities	3	1, 2, 4

Grade 4

Content Focus	Focus Standard	Teaching and Reinforcing Standard
Kansas and regions of the United States (U.S.)	5	1, 2, 3, 4

Grade 5

Content Focus	Focus Standard	Teaching and Reinforcing Standard
U.S. History (Early North American People Groups - 1789 C.E.)	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	1, 2, 3, 4, 5

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT**Grades 6-8 Middle Level**

Content Focus	Grade	Focus Standard	Teaching and Reinforcing Standard
Ancient World Civilization and History content focuses on early civilizations to 1300 C.E.	6	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	1, 2, 3, 4, 5*
Global Geography	7	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	1, 2, 3, 4, 5*
Kansas History (no earlier than seventh grade) prehistoric to present.	7	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	1, 2, 3, 4, 5*
U.S. History 1789-1898 C.E.	8	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	1, 2, 3, 4, 5*

* Elective Courses will teach and reinforce all five standards.

Grades 9-12 High Level

Content Focus	Focus Standard	Teaching and Reinforcing Standard
World Civilization and History content focuses on circa 1000 C.E. to present.	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	1, 2, 3, 4, 5*
U.S. History 1898 C.E. through the present.	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	1, 2, 3, 4, 5*
Governments of the U.S.	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	1, 2, 3, 4, 5*

* Elective Courses will teach and reinforce all five standards.

See the [HGSS Standards Appendices](#)³

³ KSDE.(2020). *Kansas History, Government and Social Studies Standards*. pages 19-246.
<https://www.ksde.gov/Agency/Division-of-Learning-Services/Career-Standards-and-Assessment-Services/Content-Area-F-L/History-Government-and-Social-Studies>

Instructional Guidance

Effective social studies instruction requires students to acquire and apply content knowledge. Students will make a claim/thesis, use evidence and reasoning, to solve problems, struggle with complex text, contextualize, produce well-organized products, and share solutions. The following structure may assist you as you create standards aligned units of study.

Instructional Guidance for the Elementary Classroom

The Kansas State Department of Education has identified four core content areas: Science, Mathematics, HGSS (History, Government, Social Studies) and English Language Arts (ELA). Each core content discipline requires systematic, explicit, scaffolded and differentiated classroom instruction at grade level. This practice ensures that educators provide the appropriate depth and rigor of core content standards for all elementary students.

In order to provide all Kansas students with access to a high quality, standards aligned education, students need to be able to build and activate background knowledge in all core content areas. Science and Social Studies should not be eliminated to garner more time for other content areas as they are critical components of knowledge building in reading development, therefore they require their own explicit instruction time.

The schedule of an elementary day should be a reflection of relevant screening and formative assessment data and may vary from day to day. The Kansas State Department of Education is not prescriptive in the number of minutes dedicated to each discipline. Below is the KSDE recommendation based on current research (links provided below).

Time Recommendations Per Day (Minimum)

- 45 Minute HGSS Block
- 45 Minute Science Block
- 90 Minute Literacy Block (core instruction with additional time for tiered interventions)
- 90 Minute Mathematics Block (60 minutes core instruction with 30 additional minutes for tiered interventions)

The quality of instruction should be prioritized over the quantity. Effective integration of content areas can make learning more meaningful. Effective integration connects explicitly and clearly to the standards and assesses multiple content standards equally (CCSSO, 2023)^{4, 5}.

4 Cabell, S., and Hwang, H. J. (2020). Building Content Knowledge to Boost Comprehension in the Primary Grades. *Reading Research Quarterly*, 55(S1), S99–S107.

5 CCSSO (2023). *Effective Social Studies Integration in Elementary Classrooms*.
Bennett, L., and Hinde, E. R. (2015). *Becoming Integrated Thinkers: Case studies in Elementary Social Studies*. National Council for the Social Studies.
Kansas Multi-Tier System of Supports Structuring Guide: Reading. (2023-2024). Kansas MTSS and Alignment, p. 16-26.
Kober, N., Carlone, H., Davis, E.A., Dominguez, X., Manz, E., and Zembal-Saul, C. 2023. *Rise and Thrive with Science: Teaching PK-5 Science and Engineering*. Washington, DC: The National Academies Press.
Randolph, G. (2021). *The Relationship Between Number of Instructional Minutes and Science and Mathematics Achievement in Elementary Schools*. Dissertations.
Underwood, S. (2018). *Evidence For an Uninterrupted Literacy Instruction Block Literacy Brief*. Education Northwest.

INSTRUCTIONAL GUIDANCE

Start With the Standards

The concepts embedded in the five Standards are intended to be applied across all HGSS disciplines and grade-levels. A kindergarten student can see that “*choices have consequences*” as they explore and analyze playground rules, while a high school student might examine the relationship between government policies and their impact on individual citizens. Educators will create activities and units of study by selecting one or two standards that align with the grade level suggested content they wish students to learn and the skills necessary to uncover and apply the content.

Choose Content and Develop Compelling Questions

Select content that aligns to the HGSS standards, while considering various factors such as relevance, complexity, and alignment with learning objectives. Compelling questions aim to foster critical thinking, inquiry, and engagement and should provoke curiosity, encourage exploration, and prompt deeper understanding of the content, while inviting students to analyze, evaluate, and synthesize information. See the [HGSS Classroom-Based Assessments Toolkit \(CBA\) Toolkit⁶](#) on the KSDE website for assistance with the creation of compelling questions.

Plan Activities With Benchmarks as Guide

The four Benchmarks⁷ are associated with each HGSS standards and are intended to provide concrete and measurable progression of disciplinary skills that students will demonstrate. They are applied appropriately across all grade-levels and content areas.

Curate Resources

Whether answering questions, developing a claim/thesis, or supporting arguments, evidence is required. Units of study will include the use of a variety of primary and secondary sources for students to investigate. Instructional design requires the careful and intentional selection, collection and organization of these types of online and print resources used by students.

The skill of gathering useful credible and reliable evidence is a critical skill for informed and knowledgeable citizens. **Educators must balance providing necessary resources and training students to discover quality resources independently.**

6 KSDE.(2023). *History, Government and Social Studies Classroom-Based Assessments Toolkit* (PDF): <https://www.ksde.gov/Agency/Division-of-Learning-Services/Career-Standards-and-Assessment-Services/Content-Area-F-L/History-Government-and-Social-Studies>

7 Grade level standards and benchmarks (see pages 9-13).

History, Government, and Social Studies (HGSS)

Content and Skills Unit Planning Tool

(The unit plan of study is designed to assist educators as they intentionally link the Kansas State Department of Education HGSS Standards with units in the classroom. **This is not meant to replace daily lesson planning.** Follow the steps below to complete this unit planning.)

STEP 1: Unit Content *(Identify the essential content covered in the unit. For example, The Vietnam Era, Bleeding Kansas, regions of Kansas, etc.)*

STEP 2: Focus Standard *(Select the HGSS standard and benchmarks that will inform the instruction for the unit. Your instruction may change depending on the focus standard selected. Use the HGSS benchmark sentence starters to aid in building your unit.)*

1. The student will recognize and evaluate ...
2. The student will analyze the context and draw conclusions about ...
3. The student will investigate and connect _____ with contemporary issues.
4. The student will use their understanding of _____ to make a claim or advance a thesis using evidence and argument.

STEP 3: HGSS Supporting Standard(s) *(Identify which HGSS standards will best support the unit. Not all remaining standards will be utilized.)*

STEP 4: Compelling Question(s) *(As compelling questions typically focus on a narrow amount of content, you may have several compelling questions depending on the scope of the unit. Refer to page 7 of the Classroom-Based Assessment Toolkit for compelling question ideas.)*

STEP 5: Assessment Connections: *(How does this unit prepare teachers and students for a classroom-based assessment?)*

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KNOW STEP 6: Identify social studies content concepts (big ideas) covered in the unit. <i>(What students will know.)</i>	DO STEP 7: Identify social studies disciplinary skills and literacies embedded in the unit and the DOK levels 1-4 for each literacy and skill. <i>(What students will be able to do.)</i>	RESOURCES STEP 8: Identify social studies sources <i>(primary and secondary)</i>

Webb's Depth of Knowledge

SOCIAL STUDIES

Summary of Definitions for Webb's Depth of Knowledge (DOK)⁸

DOK 1: Requires students to recall facts (who, what, when, and where), terms, concepts, trends, generalizations, and theories. May require students to recognize or identify specific information contained in maps, charts, tables, graphs, drawings, or other graphics.

Examples:

- Recall or recognize an event, map, or document.
- Identify key figures in a particular context.
- Recognize different types of sources.
- Identify the roles and responsibilities of individuals, groups, parties and institutions.
- Explain the meaning of a key term, such as unemployment.

DOK 2: Requires students to explain, compare, and/or contrast people, places, events, and concepts; give examples, classify or sort items into meaningful categories; describe or explain issues, problems, patterns, reasons, causes, effects, significance, impact, costs, benefits, relationships, points of view, and/or processes.

Examples:

- Describe the causes/effects of particular events.
- Identify patterns in events or behavior.
- Categorize events or figures into meaningful groupings.
- Draw connections between and among concepts and ideas and/or parts of a system.

DOK 3: Requires students to use social science practices to evaluate events and decisions from divergent perspectives; justify arguments through deliberation and evidence. May involve making connections across time and place; modeling relationships, identifying assumptions, and determining probable consequences of different courses of action.

Examples:

- Analyze how changes have influenced people or places.
- Construct questions suitable for inquiry.
- Use evidence to develop and/or critique claims and counter-claims.
- Propose and/or evaluate solutions to problems.
- Gather and evaluate sources of information for credibility and other factors.
- Analyze factors that shape perspectives.

DOK 4: Requires abstract and involved reasoning over an extended time (days, weeks). Involves planning, developing, and revising.

Involves authentic use of social science constructs to investigate a historical, political, cultural, economic, and/or geographic phenomenon, trend, event, and/or era. A project that requires extended time but only lower-DOK tasks is not DOK 4.

Examples:

- Use evidence and sound reasoning to develop explanations and arguments, propose solutions, or evaluate and communicate the causes of problems at different scales.
- Evaluate political, social, historical, cultural, economic, and/or geographical themes and how they interrelate. For example, build and communicate an argument about the economic consequences of war on the U.S. economy in the 21st century.

⁸ Wisconsin Center for Education Products and Services [WCEPS]. (2020). *WebbAlign Summary Definitions for Webb's Depth of Knowledge (DOK)* [PDF]. WCEPS. <https://www.webbalignment.org/dok-summary-tables>

HGSS Standards and Benchmarks

Standard 1. Choices have consequences.

- 1.1 The student will recognize and evaluate significant choices and consequences that have impacted our lives and futures.
- 1.2 The student will analyze the context and draw conclusions about choices and consequences.
- 1.3 The student will investigate and connect examples of choices and consequences with contemporary issues.
- 1.4 The student will use their understanding of choices and consequences to make a claim or advance a thesis using evidence and argument.

Standard 2. Individuals have rights and responsibilities.

- 2.1 The student will recognize and evaluate the rights and responsibilities of people living in societies.
- 2.2 The student will analyze the context and draw conclusions about rights and responsibilities.
- 2.3 The student will investigate and connect the rights and responsibilities of individuals with contemporary issues.
- 2.4 The student will use their understanding of rights and responsibilities to make a claim or advance a thesis using evidence and argument.

Standard 3. Societies are shaped by identities, beliefs and practices of individuals and groups.

- 3.1 The student will recognize and evaluate how societies are shaped by the identities, beliefs, and practices of individuals and groups.
- 3.2 The student will analyze context and draw conclusions of how societies are shaped by the identities, beliefs, and practices of individuals and groups.
- 3.3 The student will investigate and connect how societies are shaped by the identities, beliefs, and practices of individuals and groups with contemporary issues.
- 3.4 The student will use their understanding of how societies are shaped by the identities, beliefs, and practices of individuals and groups to make a claim or advance a thesis using evidence and argument.

Standard 4. Societies experience continuity and change over time.

- 4.1 The student will recognize and evaluate continuity and change over time.
- 4.2 The student will analyze the context and draw conclusions about continuity and change.
- 4.3 The student will investigate and connect continuity and change to a contemporary issue.
- 4.4 The student will use their understanding of continuity and change to make a claim or advance a thesis using evidence and argument.

Standard 5. Relationships among people, places, ideas and environments are dynamic.

- 5.1 The student will recognize and evaluate dynamic relationships that impact lives in communities, states, and nations.
- 5.2 The student will analyze the context and draw conclusions about dynamic relationships.
- 5.3 The student will investigate and connect dynamic relationships to contemporary issues.
- 5.4 The student will use their understanding of dynamic relationships to make a claim or advance a thesis using evidence and argument.

Evaluating High-Quality Instructional Materials

Assessing High-Quality Curricular Materials

The need for high-quality instructional materials that align to HGSS standards and meet a high level of rigor is key to student success. When assessing curricular materials for adoption, it is imperative to consider not only standards alignment but also HGSS practices, equity and inclusion, usability, instructional supports, and assessment practices. The American Institute for Research (AIR) has developed an evaluation tool for assessing social studies curricula.

AIR: [Criteria for High-Quality Instructional Materials for Social Studies](https://www.air.org/sites/default/files/2024-01/23-23505_HQIM_for_SS_Final.pdf)⁹

⁹ *Criteria for High-Quality instructional Materials for Social Studies*. (2024).
https://www.air.org/sites/default/files/2024-01/23-23505_HQIM_for_SS_Final.pdf

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Assessing High-Quality Supplemental Materials

Assessing high-quality curricular materials is important, but all too often, social studies educators need to fill curricular gaps with supplemental materials. The following checklist has been designed to assist educators in evaluating and determining if supplemental materials are high-quality and align with HGSS standards, support discipline-specific skills, and are grounded in accurate and reliable information.

As more boxes are checked, the likelihood of the supplemental material being high-quality increases.

Title of source: _____

Author: _____ Date: _____

- ☐ Does the content of the supplemental material align to at least one of the HGSS Standards. If so, identify which standard the supplemental material most closely aligns. This standard will serve as the focus standard.

SUPPLEMENTAL MATERIAL CHECKLIST: CRITICAL ELEMENTS

- ☐ Does the content of the supplemental material align within the grade level suggested Scope and Sequence?
- ☐ Does the supplemental material prioritize inquiry-based learning?
- ☐ Does the supplemental material prioritize student agency?
- ☐ Is the content of the supplemental material accurate, reliable, and can the biases be determined?
- ☐ Does the supplemental material include a variety of Social Studies discipline specific skills?

Check all that apply:

- ☐ Historical Thinking (sourcing, contextualization, cause and effect, analysis, close reading, identifying bias.)
- ☐ Historical Research and Writing.
- ☐ Civic Engagement and Civil Dialogue.
- ☐ Critical Thinking and Analyzing information.
- ☐ Analyzing secondary and primary sources.
- ☐ Claim, Evidence, and Reasoning (CER).
- ☐ Identify contrast and comparing information.
- ☐ Developing a claim/thesis statement, supporting evidence, and counter arguments
- ☐ Chronological Thinking
- ☐ Historical Comprehension
- ☐ Historical Analysis and Decision-Making
- ☐ Historical Reasoning and Interpretation
- ☐ Developing compelling questions
- ☐ Creating and supporting a Historical argument

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- ☐ Does the supplemental material utilize a variety of primary and secondary sources as part of the learning?
 - ☐ Primary sources are included.
 - ☐ Secondary sources are included.
- ☐ Does the supplemental material appropriately include voices from multiple perspectives?
- ☐ Are the provided instructional learning progressions of the supplemental material appropriately and sufficiently scaffolded? Or is the educator expected to provide them. If so, check all of the Benchmark/DOK levels that are intentionally included within the supplemental material. See the HGSS Benchmarks and/or WebbAlign^{®7} DOK for assistance.
 - ☐ Benchmark/DOK level 1.
 - ☐ Benchmark/DOK level 2.
 - ☐ Benchmark/DOK level 3.
 - ☐ Benchmark/DOK level 4.

SUPPORTING CONSIDERATIONS

- ☐ Does the supplemental material incorporate multiple social studies disciplines?
Check all that apply.
 - ☐ History
 - ☐ Economics
 - ☐ Civics/Government
 - ☐ Geography
 - ☐ Humanities
 - ☐ Other(s): _____
- ☐ Does the supplemental material include appropriately targeted learning questions? Or will the educator be expected to create these? These may include compelling questions as defined in this document.
- ☐ Does the supplemental material include both formative and summative assessment(s) opportunities that challenge students to answer a compelling question using claim/thesis, evidence and reasoning? Or will the educator be expected to create these?
- ☐ Does the supplemental material provide access for all students? Or will the educator be expected to create these?
- ☐ Could the supplemental material's summative task be assessed using the CBA Rubric?

INSTRUCTIONAL GUIDANCE

Constructive Coaching Tool for Developing High-Quality Instruction and Implementation

The following HGSS Constructive Coaching Tool conversation starters were developed to elicit meaningful and constructive discussions between observers and classroom educators to improve social studies instruction, learning, and implementation. These conversation starters can be used in multiple ways for observation, reflection and refining of best practices including the four fundamentals: structured literacy, standards alignment, balanced assessment, and quality instruction. Ideally, teachers and observers will each answer applicable questions before having a conversation. You may, as an introduction to the coaching process, agree to preselect two or three questions to focus your conversation.

HIGH-QUALITY INSTRUCTIONAL PRACTICES

Observer Observations	Conversation Starters	Educator Self-Reflection
	How is the lesson connected to previous, current and future learnings?	
	How is rigor intentionally included in the lesson? How did the lesson progress students through varying levels of depth of knowledge? (such as primary sources, complex text, Tier 2 and 3 vocabulary, compelling questions, etc.)	
	How are students actively engaged and interacting in the lesson? (such as decision-making, problem solving, reasoning, and persevering)	
	How is the lesson aligned to HGSS standards and benchmarks? Which HGSS standard(s) best align to this lesson?	
	How did the lesson incorporate high-quality curricular and supplemental materials, and how did they enhance the lesson?	
	How did students demonstrate agency—struggles and successes?	

INSTRUCTIONAL GUIDANCE**HIGH-QUALITY HGSS CONTENT AND SKILLS**

Observer Observations	Conversation Starters	Educator Self-Reflection
	How are compelling questions and/or tasks used by students to support and deepen understanding of their content?	
	Is accuracy of the content ensured, including the use of multiple perspectives and recognizing bias?	
	How do students demonstrate appropriate HGSS skills (such as claim, evidence, reasoning, counterarguments, etc.)?	
	How are supports used for students that allow for critical thinking and questioning?	
	Which HGSS skills are evident in the lesson, how are students provided opportunities to practice and access appropriate course-specific tasks, and how were they measured to show mastery?	
	How are explanations, representations, and/or examples used to make the focus of the lesson visible to students without just providing the answer?	
	How is student content understanding strengthened? If misconceptions are present how were those clarified or corrected?	

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HIGH-QUALITY PROFESSIONAL GROWTH REFLECTION

Observer Observations	Conversation Starters	Educator Self-Reflection
	Reflect on the growth opportunities you see for this lesson in the future?	
	What high quality materials are available or could be obtained to support instruction in this classroom? (Such as subscriptions, technology, PD opportunities, conferences, etc.)	
	What opportunities for growth and development are supported by this administration/district/school?	

Classroom-Based Assessment Toolkit and Rubrics

Kansas Social Studies Classroom-Based Assessments (CBAs) are designed to measure student mastery of the History, Government and Social Studies standards, benchmarks and skills. CBAs provide Kansas school districts, classroom educators and students the opportunity to develop their own assessments that best support community decisions concerning content, sources and product choices. CBAs are based on the fourth benchmark of each standard as outlined in the HGSS standards document. CBAs are a scaffolded DOK task. CBAs specifically ask students to create products demonstrating their performance level in advancing a claim/thesis and supporting that claim/thesis using evidence and reasoning skills. Examples include students utilizing skills such as evaluating information, analyzing evidence, making connections, and advancing a claim/thesis are found in the table below. CBAs build students towards the construction of a product that can be assessed using the CBA Rubric. CBAs can be used throughout the school year to help students develop their Claim, Evidence, and Reasoning skills. For more information concerning the creation of Classroom Based Assessments use the link below or visit the KSDE website.

[HGSS Classroom-Based Assessments Toolkit \(CBA\) Toolkit²](#)

CBA DESCRIPTION AND CRITERIA

Using skills developed during instructional tasks and activities, a student will create a cohesive product using grade-level appropriate communication skills that answer a locally developed compelling question focused on one or more of the big ideas from the five standards (i.e., choices, consequences, rights, responsibilities, identities, beliefs, ideas, actions, continuity, change or dynamic relationships).

To earn a proficient score using the KSDE Classroom-Based Assessment rubric, a student product must include:

- The **claim/thesis** includes a clear and accurate reason that answers the compelling question using evidence.
- The **evidence** is from at least one relevant, trusted and accurate source that supports the claim/thesis **AND** tells where it came from and who created it.
- The **reasoning** clearly connects at least one piece of primary or secondary evidence to support the claim/thesis.

INSTRUCTIONAL GUIDANCE

Elementary School CBA Rubric

This classroom-based assessment (CBA) rubric will be used to measure student products that **MUST** include claim/thesis, evidence and reasoning.

CBA compelling question:

Standard(s) addressed by the compelling question:

ELEMENTARY SCHOOL

Scoring Category	PERFORMANCE LEVELS				Score
	1 Beginning	2 Developing	3 Proficient	4 Exemplary	
Claim/Thesis: A statement that answers the compelling question using evidence.	The Claim/Thesis is absent OR is unclear.	The Claim/Thesis is unclear, inaccurate or vague OR includes a reason that does not provide support for the argument.	The Claim/Thesis includes a clear and accurate reason that answers the compelling question using evidence.	The Claim/Thesis includes two or more clear and accurate reasons that answer the compelling question using evidence.	Claim/Thesis Score:
Evidence: The details from the sources that supports the claim/thesis and prove it to be true.	The Evidence is absent OR is unclear.	The Evidence includes some evidence that is vague OR is not accurate, that inadequately supports the claim/thesis AND doesn't tell where it came from and who created it.	The Evidence is from at least one relevant, trusted and accurate source that supports the claim/thesis AND tells where it came from and who created it.	The Evidence is from two or more relevant, trusted and accurate sources that supports the claim/thesis AND tells where it came from and who created it.	Evidence Score:
Reasoning: The explanation of the evidence and how it proves the claim/thesis to be true.	The Reasoning is absent OR is unclear.	The Reasoning tries to connect one piece of evidence but the connection isn't clear or is confusing.	The Reasoning clearly connects at least one piece of primary or secondary evidence to support the claim/thesis.	The Reasoning clearly connects at least two pieces of primary and/or secondary evidence to support the claim/thesis.	Reasoning Score:

INSTRUCTIONAL GUIDANCE

Middle School CBA Rubric

This classroom-based assessment (CBA) rubric will be used to measure student products that **MUST** include claim/thesis, evidence and reasoning.

CBA compelling question:

Standard(s) addressed by the compelling question:

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Scoring Category	PERFORMANCE LEVELS				Score
	1 Beginning	2 Developing	3 Proficient	4 Exemplary	
Claim/ Thesis: A statement that answers the compelling question using evidence.	The Claim/Thesis is absent OR is unclear.	The Claim/ Thesis is unclear, inaccurate or vague AND includes only one relevant reason OR includes a reason or reasons that do not provide support for the argument.	The Claim/Thesis includes a clear and accurate argument that answers the compelling question AND includes two relevant reasons that support the argument using evidence.	The Claim/ Thesis includes a detailed and complex argument that answers the compelling question AND includes at least three relevant reasons that support and strengthen the argument using evidence.	Claim Score:
Evidence: The details from the sources that supports the claim and prove it to be true.	The Evidence is absent OR includes only vague information or background knowledge that is unrelated to the compelling question AND is not appropriately cited.	The Evidence is unclear, inaccurate or vague AND includes only one relevant and accurate primary and/or secondary source that inadequately supports the claim/thesis AND is not appropriately cited.	The Evidence is from two relevant primary sources from two perspectives (secondary source as needed). It is credible; clear; accurate; supports the claim/ thesis; answers the compelling question, showing an understanding of source material; AND is appropriately cited.	The Evidence is from three or more relevant and corroborated primary and secondary sources from multiple perspectives. It is credible; clear; accurate; contextualized; supports the claim/ thesis; answers the compelling question, showing a comprehensive understanding of source material that advances the argument; AND is appropriately cited.	Evidence Score:

INSTRUCTIONAL GUIDANCE

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Scoring Category	PERFORMANCE LEVELS				Score
	1 Beginning	2 Developing	3 Proficient	4 Exemplary	
Reasoning: The explanation of the evidence and how it proves the claim to be true.	The Reasoning is absent OR does not explain the connection of the evidence to the claim/thesis.	The Reasoning provides a vague explanation for using the evidence OR does not clearly connect the evidence to the claim/thesis.	The Reasoning provides a clear explanation that connects the evidence to the claim/thesis AND answers the compelling question.	The Reasoning provides a sophisticated explanation that connects the evidence and the claim/thesis AND recognizes and includes a counter-argument.	Reasoning Score:

High School CBA Rubric

This classroom-based assessment (CBA) rubric will be used to measure student products that **MUST** include claim/thesis, evidence and reasoning.

CBA compelling question:

Standard(s) addressed by the compelling question:

HIGH SCHOOL

Scoring Category	PERFORMANCE LEVELS				Score
	1 Beginning	2 Developing	3 Proficient	4 Exemplary	
Claim/Thesis: A statement that answers the compelling question using evidence.	The Claim/ Thesis is absent OR is unclear.	The Claim/ Thesis is unclear, inaccurate or vague AND includes only one relevant reason OR includes a reason or reasons that do not provide support for the argument.	The Claim/ Thesis includes a clear and accurate argument that answers the compelling question, AND includes two relevant reasons that support the argument using evidence.	The Claim/ Thesis includes a detailed and complex argument that answers the compelling question, AND Includes at least three relevant reasons that support and strengthen the argument using evidence.	Claim/ Thesis Score:

INSTRUCTIONAL GUIDANCE

HIGH SCHOOL

Scoring Category	PERFORMANCE LEVELS				Score
	1 Beginning	2 Developing	3 Proficient	4 Exemplary	
Evidence: The details from the sources that supports the claim and prove it to be true.	The Evidence is absent OR includes only vague information or background knowledge that is unrelated to the compelling question AND is not appropriately cited.	The Evidence is from limited and uncorroborated primary sources. It is unclear; inaccurate; inadequately supports the compelling question, showing little understanding of source material; AND isn't cited appropriately.	The Evidence is from two or more relevant and corroborated primary sources from multiple perspectives and may also include secondary sources as needed. It is credible; clear; accurate; supports the claim/thesis; answers the compelling question, showing an understanding of source material; AND is appropriately cited.	The Evidence is from three or more relevant and corroborated primary and secondary sources from multiple perspectives. It is credible; clear; accurate; supports the claim/thesis; contextualized; answers the compelling question, showing a comprehensive understanding of source material that advances the argument; AND is appropriately cited.	Evidence Score:
Reasoning: The explanation of the evidence and how it proves the claim to be true.	The Reasoning doesn't provide logical or specific reasoning OR doesn't connect the evidence to the claim/thesis, AND the counterargument is absent.	The Reasoning provides unclear or incorrect reasoning for using the evidence OR doesn't clearly connect the evidence to the claim/thesis, AND the counterargument is absent.	The Reasoning provides a clear explanation that connects the evidence to the claim/thesis and answers the compelling question AND recognizes a counterargument.	The Reasoning provides a sophisticated explanation that connects the evidence to the claim/thesis and advances the argument beyond simply answering the compelling question; AND recognizes, analyzes and challenges one or more counterarguments.	Reasoning Score:

Glossary of Terms

Term	Description
Benchmark	A measurable expectation of student performance.
CBA	Classroom-based assessment.
Claim/Thesis	A statement made by a student that answers the compelling question.
Compelling question	A question that is open-ended, debatable, launches and guides an inquiry/ investigation, and requires an evidence based claim.
Disciplinary Thinking Skills	The critical thinking skills that are specific to the HGSS disciplines. Among others, these include analyzing problems, collecting information, evaluating sources and creating solutions. It's what the CBA is designed to measure.
Evidence	The details from the source(s) that support the claim/thesis and prove it to be true.
Focus Standard	A "focused standard" drives the unit of study for the purposes of developing instruction and assessment (formative and summative).
HGSS	History, Government and Social Studies
HQIM	High-Quality Instructional Materials
Inquiry	The act of asking questions used to investigate compelling questions.
Primary source	Primary sources are the raw materials of history - original documents and objects that were created at the time under study. Any piece of writing, image, video, sound recording or human-made object can be a primary source.
Secondary source	A secondary source does not give original information. It interprets or summarizes information from primary sources. Textbooks, biographies and encyclopedias are examples of secondary sources.
Reasoning	The explanation of the evidence and how it proves the claim/thesis to be true.
Standard(s)	An overarching learning goal for students that guides instruction across grade levels. Kansas curricular standards are guidelines school districts can use to develop their curriculum. They are not the curriculum or content.
Unit of study	A specific area of content to be taught within a given curriculum.
Vertical alignment	The coordination and coherence of learning objectives, content, and skills across different grade levels or educational stages within a particular subject or curriculum. It ensures a smooth progression of learning from basic to more advanced concepts, allowing students to build upon their knowledge and skills systematically as they move through their education.

References

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VISION

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MOTTO

Kansans Can

SUCCESS DEFINED

A successful Kansas high school graduate has the

- Academic preparation,
- Cognitive preparation,
- Technical skills,
- Employability skills and
- Civic engagement

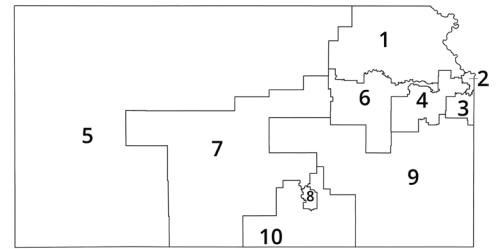
to be successful in postsecondary education, in the attainment of an industry recognized certification or in the workforce, without the need for remediation.

OUTCOMES

- Social-emotional growth
- Kindergarten readiness
- Individual Plan of Study
- Civic engagement
- Academically prepared for postsecondary
- High school graduation
- Postsecondary success



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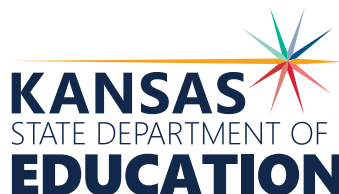


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